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ANDROID The Backbone of Future Connected Cars

Google is developing a full-fledged Android OS for cars, giving connected cars a tighter, more familiar platform to work on.

Souvik Das | souvik@digit.in

Connected cars are not a laboratory blueprint any more - automobile researchers around the world have started rolling out car-specific telematics across multiple segments of cars. The objective is to provide a connected web that collates, exchanges and governs on-road data from cars pertaining to road and weather conditions, as well as car dynamics, facilitating a

wide network of vehicles that can be safer, predict smarter routes, prevent untimely breakdowns.

It came as no surprise when Google decided to integrate Android directly into cars in the future. The Internet giant has been exploring this model for a few years, Google's intentions were made clear about a year ago. With Android Auto (AA), Google made its initial foray into in-car technology, and AA has subsequently found

its way to a wide range of infotainment systems offered by car makers today. However, Android Auto relies too heavily on the smartphone, and Google had no intention of remaining confined within the limits of what a smartphone can achieve. The solution? Use the already-versatile and massively popular Android OS to build a standalone OS for cars.

Last year, Google struck a partnership with Volvo and Audi, as initial